The Mountainside

A Publication of the Coolfont Mountainside Association

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www.geocities.com/coolfontmountainside

THE DACC:

WHAT THEY DO, AND WHY THEY DO IT!

At the heart of it all, people have chosen Coolfont because of the uparallelled quality of our community.

Part of the effort to keep that quality high -and protect our individual and community investment - is the all-volunteer work of the DACC - the Design and Architectural Control Committee.

The DACC, currently chaired by Jim Thompson, is charged with insuring your new house - or your changes to your older house - conform to the basic CMA standards for materials and design, and fit with the look and feel of our neighborhood.

Why go to all this effort? A community with consistent appearance and quality standards is a community where home values steadily appreciate. That's real money - beyond the benefits of beauty and tranquility. When you make changes or build new, contact the DACC first!



Inspecting the work in progress on the new CMA bath / changing room and CMA office building are Board members (from left) Jim Thompson, Elmer Broxson and Paul Kagan.

BOARD MEETINGS and POTLUCK DINNER SHEDULE

March 16
Board: Dring's 0-1

April 20

May 18

June 15

The CMA Social Committee wants to continue the tradition of having potluck dinners on the Saturday evenings of our Board meetings. With many newcomers to the CMA community, the Committee wants to especially encourage the new members to join in. Everyone who has been to the potlucks knows what a great opportunity they are to meet new neighbors and just have a great time!!! We now are looking for volunteers for the spring season which includes March, April, May and June. Remember, if you are a host, the BARN may be used during the warmer months (it is not heated) if you choose not to use your home.....it's up to you. The dates are: March 16, April 20, May 18 and June 15. If you wish to host any one of these, please call Joan Hash, Committee Chair, at 410.461.3834 or send her an email at joybert@aol.com. It's easy and Joan can explain what is involved in hosting.

Want to Know What's Happening Faster?

If you would like to receive notification of monthly board meeting, potlucks and other CMA information via e-mail, please send you address to Joan Bradfield, CMA Secretary at : jbradfield1 @juno.com.

CMA SOCIAL/ COMMUNICATIONS REPORT by Joan Hash

The Social and Communications Committee sponsored a "winter' potluck in December at the home of Katherine Farquher (Q9). Although it snowed, the potluck went off as planned and all who attended had a great evening.

The November potluck, hosted by the Yinglings was also wonderful, and enjoyed by all.

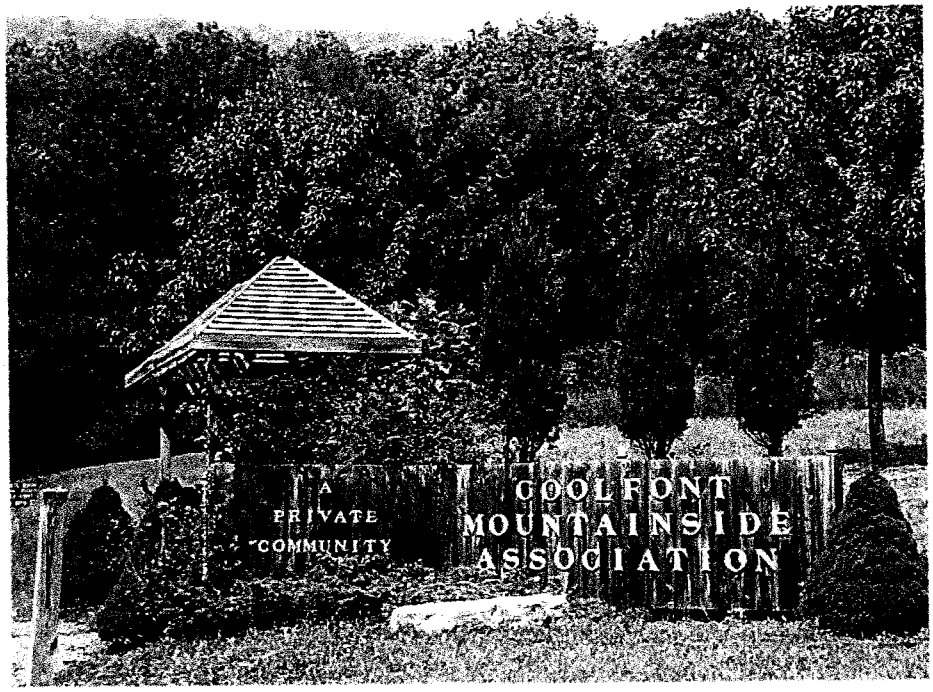
If members have ideas about other events they'd like to see the Committee initiate, please call Joan Hash , Committee Chair, at 410-461-3834 or send her email (joybert@aol.com).

Also, as mentioned on the previous page, anyone wishing to volunteer to host a potluck should let her know also. The Committee is always looking for volunteers!

As usual, we are still looking for good suggestions for our Webmaster, Bob Borchers, to expand and enhance our CMA website. Please send him all your good ideas.

Have you visited the website lately? Click on: www.geocities.com/ coolfont_mountainside

Joan Hash



The President's Corner:

Muskrats And Other Critters

Most of us are fond of the wild life on the mountainside. Our four legged and winged friends, and those that creep, slither, swarm and swim, contribute to the environment that attracted us to the area in the first place. The occasional sightings of snakes and bears do ring internal alarm bells and cause us to take care of where we step and to refrain from leaving food outside. More than a few of us have built screened in porches to get away from the little summer flying things. Still, it's a lot safer and more pleasant than the heavy traffic and other dangerous and annoying aspects of the city.

Once in a while a critter will step over the line. The last time I inquired, one of my fellow board members was still trying to discover how the squirrels get into her house. Some muskrats are also going where they are not supposed to go.

Our waste water treatment pond has an earthen dam which the muskrats like to bore into for food. The problem is they can bore right through or cause leaks which can end up destroying the dam. The solution was to hire a trapper to catch the rascals.

The mountainside house my wife and I live in is not called Lady Bug house for nothing. Somehow, year after year, large numbers of lady bugs seem to prefer to hang around our ceilings than go outside and look for aphids.

Periodically, we sweep them up or chase them out.

Most of the time drastic action is unnecessary. The builder who constructed our home told us a story about a woodpecker who insisted on pecking holes on the side of a neighbors house. The neighbor asked the contractor what he should do. The contractor told him he had two choices. He could shoot the bird or learn to coexist with him. Hopefully the neighbor got the message and did not shoot the bird.

Speaking of builders, most of those in our area are conscientious and try to do a good job. Some have a different work ethic. One recently took some trees down and cleared a building site on the mountainside before he was authorized to do so. A number of association members have told me about problems with that builder and others: poor workmanship, incorrect installation of wiring and other systems, failure to properly finish portions of the house, and the like. The board of directors is compiling a data base of information about builders and contractors to be made available to members of the community.

If you have information that should be shared about the creatures of the forest , or if you would like to know what to do about those that are causing problems, call our operations manager, John Hobday. If you have information about builders and contractors who do good work, or who cause problems, contact me or any other member of the board.

Richard Kaufman

DACC and Adjoining Lands Committees

by Jim Thompson - Chair

DACC

There has been a lot of activity in the last three months with several new applications and inquiries for building new homes at Coolfont. The T-section is completely sold and a number of the lot owners there as well as other locations are working with DACC on house plans.

DACC Regulations and Guidelines

The current DACC *"Regulations and Guidelines for Building at Coolfont"* have not been updated since 1995. I have scanned the current version and now have an electronic copy. I am reviewing it for obvious things that need to be changed and will provide a draft in March. I expect to post it on the CMA website. I encourage anyone with comments to forward them to me at jthompso@erols.com.

Adjoining Lands

The Ashelman family had a meeting in December to decide the use of approximately 485 acres of land north of Coolfont and CMA. They are discussing the establishment of 6-8 "islands" of 25 to 40 acres each for future development. Mr. Zuohuang Chen may opt to use one of these islands for a Chinese/American Music & Cultural Center. The medical department of West Virginia University may be interested in establishing a wellness center at Coolfont. The Ashelmans want to decide usage for approximately 40 acres remaining under their ownership in the Salmon tract. CMA is working to ensure access to and security of our Salmon well that lies within those 40 acres.

Jim Thompson

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